MIT SOLVE 2027 · GLOBAL LEARNING CHALLENGE

Every question, ready to answer.

Retake, entered under "improve assessment of what learners truly know and can do". Each question on the form, in order, with what to write, what we already have, and what we must not overclaim.



> **Deadline: Friday 6 November 2026, 12:00 pm US Eastern (10:30 pm in India).** Late applications are not accepted, even for technical problems. Aim to submit by Monday 2 November.

BEFORE YOU START

How to use this workbook. Who fills what, and the rules.

The form has five sections, covered here in the same order. Every question is a card. The chip on each card says what it needs:

READY the answer is settled: copy it in. **FACTS NEEDED** only the team knows it: fill it in.

WRITE a written answer, in your own words, from the material on the card.

TEAM LEAD the team lead does this personally.

WRITE IN YOUR OWN WORDS

Solve says: "We do not recommend using generative AI tools to write your application for you", because such answers read as generic and "can strongly disadvantage your application." Use the material on each card as notes, and write the answer yourself. AI tools may then be used, as Solve suggests, to shorten a draft or check the grammar.

> **Gender and relationships education is judged by asking students what they think. Retake measures what they do. It works now with adults, and Solve's support would validate it and build the version for students.**

That is the one idea every answer comes back to. Keep the answers consistent with it.

FOUR CLAIMS WE MUST NOT MAKE

The form's Accuracy and Integrity Agreement says that exaggerating "may lead to the removal of my solution from the Challenge." So, in every answer:

- **No users yet.** The prototype has been played by the team and in walkthroughs only.
- **The student version does not exist.** What exists and works is the assessment with adult content.
- **The reading is not validated.** How many decisions a confident reading needs, and how they become one figure, is still being worked out.
- **Retake shows choices inside the game.** It does not claim a change in behaviour outside it.

GOOD TO KNOW

- **Public answers.** The Solution Profile becomes public on Solve's site if we reach the semi-finals.
- **The team lead travels.** If we are selected as Finalists, the team lead pitches and interviews with judges over Zoom in February. If we are selected as Solvers, the team lead must attend Solver Orientation in Cambridge, MA in April 2027 (Solve gives travel assistance) and the Solve Challenge Finals in New York in September. Start on the US visa early.
- **Saving.** The form saves as you go, and you can skip between sections. Nothing counts until someone clicks Submit Solution.
- **English only.** Every answer and uploaded file must be in English.

SECTION 1 · INSTRUCTIONS

Three agreements. The team lead reads and ticks them.

1 Terms of Service Agreement

REQUIRED TEAM LEAD

WHAT IT SAYS

"I agree to MIT Solve's Terms of Service, the MIT Solve Media Release and License, and the MIT Solve Privacy Policy." Read all three before ticking. The media release covers how Solve may use our name, video and materials.

2 Accuracy and Integrity Agreement

REQUIRED TEAM LEAD

WHAT IT SAYS

Fabricating, exaggerating or misrepresenting anything "may lead to the removal of my solution". If AI tools were used in writing, we confirm we have checked that every answer is accurate. This is why the four claims on page 2 matter.

3 GenAI Data Processing Consent

REQUIRED TEAM LEAD

WHAT IT SAYS

Solve may use AI tools to help process and review applications, with steps to keep personal data out of them. Read it, then tick.

SECTION 2 · SOLUTION PROFILE

Who we are and what Retake is. Public if we reach the semi-finals.

4 What is the name of your organization?

REQUIRED READY

ANSWER The Equal Lens

5 What is the name of your solution?

REQUIRED 30 CHARACTERS READY

ANSWER Retake

WHY It is the name the app already uses. Solve suggests 1 to 4 words and treats the organisation name and the solution name separately.

6 Provide a one-line summary or tagline for your solution.

REQUIRED 10 TO 20 WORDS, 150 CHARACTERS WRITE

INCLUDE

- a daily puzzle game;
- learners choose between equally qualified people;
- their choices show where gender sways a decision;
- an assessment of what learners do, not what they say.

DRAFT

7 In what city, town, or region is your solution team headquartered?

REQUIRED FACTS NEEDED

ANSWER

8 In what country is your solution team headquartered?

REQUIRED READY

ANSWER India

9 What type of organization is your solution team?

REQUIRED · FACTS NEEDED

OPTIONS For-profit · Nonprofit · Hybrid · Not registered as any organization · Other, including part of a larger organization

HOW TO CHOOSE If The Equal Lens is registered as a trust, society or Section 8 company, choose **Nonprofit**. If it is not registered yet, choose **Not registered as any organization**.

ANSWER

10 Film your elevator pitch.

OPTIONAL · UP TO 3 MINUTES · DO IT

WHY DO IT Not required, but Solve says a video helps reviewers understand the solution, and suggests showing a demo if there is a product. We have one.

HOW Record a phone playing the demo and talk over it. About **20 seconds** on the problem; **60 seconds** playing one decision; then its twin decision and what the pair shows. Close on why students next. A phone camera is enough.

SETTINGS Upload to YouTube or Vimeo as **public or unlisted**, then paste the link.

11 What specific problem are you solving?

REQUIRED · 200 WORDS · WRITE

SOLVE ASKS

The specific problem within the Challenge; its scale where we work and globally; how many people it affects; what causes it.

MATERIAL

- **Bias is near universal.** UNDP's 2023 Gender Social Norms Index: nearly 9 in 10 people worldwide hold at least one bias against women. For India the index reports 99.2%, from 2010 to 2014 survey data. *Both found in secondary reports: confirm them in the UNDP report before citing.*
- **It shows in decisions, not in what people say.** When science faculty rated identical applications from "John" and "Jennifer", John was judged more competent and hireable and offered a higher salary (Moss-Racusin and colleagues, 2012).
- **The gap is in assessment.** Gender and relationships education, including our own programmes, is judged by surveys before and after: what learners say they believe. Students soon learn the right answer to give. Teachers cannot see whether a learner can make a fair decision, or where a class still leans, so they have nothing to act on.
- **Our scale:** how many students our school programmes reach, and where. *Team: add the real numbers.*

DRAFT

12 What is your solution?

REQUIRED | 200 WORDS | WRITE

SOLVE ASKS

What it is, what it does, how it works and what technology it uses, in simple terms. About the solution, not the problem. A demo link if relevant.

MATERIAL

- **A daily puzzle app** set in five illustrated Indian worlds: a railway station, a truck depot, a travelling magic show, a cricket club and a family home.
- **Each decision** shows 3 to 5 people with their records and asks one question: who drives the night train, who captains, who does the chores.
- **Two of them have identical records**, one woman and one man. One detail differs, such as a word the speaker uses about one of them. Later, a twin decision puts that detail on the other side, with different people.
- **The reading comes from the pair.** The man both times is a lean towards men; the woman both times is a lean towards women; following the detail both times is no lean. In some twins the detail really matters, such as who holds the licence, so "always pick the woman" does not look fair.
- **Players** never see the words bias or test and never know which two match. They get a private reading and a "look again" at the pair.
- **What runs today:** a 20-minute starter of five chapters, in Hinglish, Hindi and English, installable on a phone and working offline.

DRAFT

13 Who does your solution serve, and in what ways will the solution impact their lives?

REQUIRED · 200 WORDS · WRITE

SOLVE ASKS

The people whose lives we aim to improve, how they are underserved now, and how the solution meets their needs.

MATERIAL

- **Now, adults.** We prove the assessment with adults first: testing an unvalidated measure on children would be wrong, and adults can consent to hard topics and to the use of their data.
- **Next, the aim of this application:** students aged 13 to 18 in Indian schools, through our Teen Compass (13 to 15) and Relay (16 to 18) programmes, and the teachers and facilitators who run them. Also learners in Hindi-medium and mixed-language classrooms, poorly served by English-only tools.
- **What changes for them.** Each learner gets a private reading and practice on cases they have not seen. The facilitator sees where a class leans and which situations sway it, and targets the next session there.
- **Built safe for children**, as the Challenge asks: the adult hard topics stay out; no public leaderboards for minors; each student's reading stays private; parental consent follows India's rules for children's data.

DRAFT

14 Would you like to save these answers to a Solution Profile?

READY

ANSWER

Save as a New Solution Profile

WHY

It lets us reuse these answers in later Solve applications, such as a workplace version for the Economic Prosperity Challenge.

SECTION 3 · YOUR ELIGIBILITY

Can Solve review us? Yes, at Prototype stage.

15 Is technology a core part of your solution?

REQUIRED READY

ANSWER Yes, tech is core to our solution.

WHY The assessment is the app: the paired decisions, the shuffling and the reading cannot run without it.

16 Does your solution address an educational or learning problem?

REQUIRED READY

ANSWER Yes

17 What is your solution's stage of development?

REQUIRED READY

ANSWER Prototype

WHY Solve: "an initial working version of a solution that may be in the process of getting initial feedback or testing with users... (Often 0 users)". Concept would not be reviewed at all, and Pilot needs a launch in at least one community. Solve warns that "exaggerating your progress can affect your chances of selection."

18 Please share details about why you selected the stage above.

REQUIRED · 200 WORDS · WRITE

SOLVE ASKS

What we have built and tested so far. Only what is done, not plans.

BUILT

- A playable 20-minute starter with 28 decisions across five chapters.
- Five kinds of puzzle playable today (pick one, believe, pick a team, a batting order, and sharing out chores), and six more designed.
- Five illustrated worlds and more than 50 painted characters from across India.
- Three languages: Hinglish, Hindi and English.
- A design system covering every screen.

TESTED

- Played through on phones in all three languages with no errors.
- An earlier build passed automated accessibility checks with zero issues across 141 screen visits at six screen sizes. A manual screen-reader check is still to do.
- A check that every hidden pair matches exactly on every number.

SAY PLAINLY

No one outside the team has played it yet. That is why this is a Prototype.

DRAFT

SECTION 4 · SOLUTION & TEAM DETAILS

Reach, team and contacts. Mostly facts only the team has.

19 How many beneficiaries or customers does your solution currently serve?

REQUIRED READY

ANSWER None

WHY Solve: "The option you select here will not change your chances of being selected... Be honest – exaggerating your progress can affect your chances of selection." Count only people reached by Retake itself, not by our other programmes.

20 Does your solution have a website, app, or social media handle?

REQUIRED FACTS NEEDED

TO DECIDE Yes, if we list The Equal Lens website or the demo link. The demo link is open to anyone who has it, so decide first whether to share it.

LINKS

21 Which dimension of the Challenge does your solution most closely address?

REQUIRED READY

ANSWER **Improve assessment of what learners truly know and can do, including formative assessment, diagnostics, or early screening that flag when a learner is off-track so a teacher can intervene.**

WHY This is our case: a measure of what learners do, used regularly, that shows a facilitator where to step in. Mention the multilingual and offline points in the written answers, not here.

22 How are you and your team well-positioned to deliver this solution?

REQUIRED · 300 WORDS · WRITE · FACTS NEEDED

SOLVE ASKS

Not credentials. They want the experience, relationships, data and knowledge to deliver, with **specific examples of how we have engaged the people we serve**, how many, and how that input shaped the solution.

MATERIAL

- The Equal Lens's work in schools: the three programmes and their ages (Discovery 5 to 12, Teen Compass 13 to 15, Relay 16 to 18), free to delivery partners.
- Sessions run so far: how many, where, how many students and facilitators. *Team: real numbers.*
- What learners and facilitators changed in our work, and how that fed into Retake.
- The team's background in design, research and facilitation. *Team: fill in.*
- The content is written for India: Indian settings, a cast from across the country and its faiths, three languages.

DRAFT

23 In which countries do you currently operate?

READY

ANSWER

India

24 Which, if any, additional countries will you be operating in within the next year?

FACTS NEEDED

HOW TO CHOOSE

Leave it empty unless a partner abroad is actually lined up.

25 How many people work on your solution team?

REQUIRED · 100 WORDS · FACTS NEEDED

GIVE

Separate numbers for full-time staff, part-time staff, and contractors or other workers. Count volunteers under "other" and say they are volunteers.

ANSWER

26 How long have you been working on your solution?

REQUIRED · 100 WORDS · FACTS NEEDED

GIVE

The years The Equal Lens has worked on gender and relationships education, and that Retake itself has been in development since 2026. *Team: the founding year and the month Retake started.*

ANSWER

27 Why are you applying to Solve?

REQUIRED · 300 WORDS · WRITE

SOLVE ASKS

The financial, technical, legal, cultural or market barriers Solve can help with, and how. Solve warns: "If your only goal in applying to Solve is to raise funds, Solve is not the right program for you!"

MATERIAL

- **Technical: validation.** Turn the reading into a sound assessment: how consistent it is, how many decisions a confident reading needs, and evidence that it tracks fair decisions. We need assessment and research partners for this.
- **Legal: children's safety and data.** Privacy by design and consent that meets India's rules for minors' data, before any student plays.
- **Market: the route into schools.** Partnerships with state education departments and school networks, to go beyond our own programmes.
- **Cultural: content at scale.** Puzzles adapted and checked for 13 to 18 year olds, in more Indian languages.

DRAFT

28 Who is the Team Lead for your solution?

REQUIRED · FACTS NEEDED

WHO

The head of the organisation, responsible for Retake's direction. Name only. This person pitches to judges over Zoom in February if we are Finalists, and travels to Cambridge, MA in April and New York in September if we are selected.

NAME

29 Contacts for Solve only (not seen by judges)

REQUIRED FACTS NEEDED

FILL

Team lead's email (required), team lead's phone with country code (required), and a backup contact's name, email and phone. If we are Finalists Solve writes to the team lead in early February, with a short deadline to confirm, so give an inbox someone watches. A backup contact makes sure the message is not missed.

30 Questions about the team lead and our history (Solve only)

REQUIRED FACTS NEEDED

THE QUESTIONS

- Is the Team Lead a resident of the United States? **No**, unless that changes.
- What is the Team Lead's gender? Is the Team Lead transgender? *The team lead answers, or chooses "prefer not to answer".* Solve asks for reporting only; judges never see it.
- Has anyone from our organisation been selected as a Solver before? **No**, unless someone has.
- Is the solution part of another entrepreneurship network (incubator, accelerator, fellowship)? *Team: check.*
- Did you take the MITx course "Business and Impact Planning for Social Enterprises"? Answer truthfully; it does not affect selection.
- Did you hear about Solve through a network or mailing list? *Team: check.*

Why it is new, why it will work, and how it pays for itself.

31 What makes your solution innovative?

300 WORDS WRITE

SOLVE ASKS

How it approaches the problem in a new or much improved way; how it differs from others; how it could change the field.

MATERIAL

- **Surveys can be answered to please.** Implicit tests, which time how fast people react, have a weak link to what people do: a 2019 review by Forscher and colleagues found that changing those scores did not change behaviour.
- **Retake measures the decision itself,** using the logic of the identical-CV studies, inside a game.
- **The paired design reads a lean either way,** towards men or towards women, and separates being swayed by a word from being swayed by gender.
- **A daily habit,** so the reading repeats over time: an assessment a teacher can use as it goes, not a one-off test.
- **Made for India:** Indian places, names and languages, from Hinglish to Hindi.
- **For the field:** a way to evaluate gender and relationships education by what learners do, which programmes like ours have never had.

DRAFT

32 Describe in simple terms how and why you expect your solution to have an impact on the problem.

300 WORDS WRITE

SOLVE ASKS

Our theory of change: how activities lead to outputs and to short- and long-term outcomes, with evidence for each link (research, interviews, our own data).

MATERIAL

- **Activities:** learners play short sets of paired decisions in class or at home; each gets a private reading and a "look again" at the pair they treated differently; the facilitator sees the class pattern.
- **Outputs:** a reading per learner; a class map of which situations sway decisions.
- **Short-term outcomes:** learners notice when a word or detail is doing the work; facilitators target the sessions where a class leans.
- **Long-term outcomes:** fairer decisions on cases learners have never practised, which is the gain the assessment can show; fairer choices in school and later at work.
- **Evidence for the links:** identical-application studies show that bias acts in decisions (Moss-Racusin 2012); a study of breaking prejudiced habits showed that noticing and practice can reduce bias (Devine and colleagues, 2012). *Team: add anything from our own sessions.*
- **The honest gap:** whether a change inside the game carries into real life is what the pilot will test.

DRAFT

33 Describe your solution's tech stack and how you know that it works.

300 WORDS · WRITE

SOLVE ASKS

The technology, and proof that it works. For new technology, a paper or other public evidence.

MATERIAL

- **The app:** a web app that installs on a phone and works offline (a Progressive Web App), built in React and TypeScript. The puzzles are data, so new content needs no new code. Three languages switch on every screen.
- **The reading:** every decision has a twin built to the same rules. An automated check refuses any set where the pair's numbers differ, where a person repeats, or where a hard fact is said of a name that marks a community.
- **The art:** illustrations are made with an open image model run on our own computer, then reviewed and corrected by hand. Learners never interact with AI, and AI plays no part in the reading.
- **How we know it works:** the playable demo (the video shows it), automated accessibility and layout checks, and written content rules that every puzzle must pass.
- **Not yet proven:** that the reading is a valid measure. Say so, and that it is the first thing the funding pays for.

DRAFT

34 Please select the technologies currently used in your solution.

READY

ANSWER

Software and Mobile Applications · Behavioral Technology

TO DECIDE

Generative AI makes the illustrations only. Tick it only if the team wants to declare that; either way, say it in question 33.

35 What is your business model?

300 WORDS · WRITE

SOLVE ASKS

How we create value for the people we serve: key customers and beneficiaries, what we give them, how, and why they want it.

MATERIAL

- **Learners and schools use it free,** as with our programmes, which are free to delivery partners.
- **Beneficiaries:** students; their teachers and facilitators, who get a class picture they can act on.
- **Customers and funders:** NGOs and school networks running gender and relationships education; later, state education departments that want to know whether such teaching works.
- **Why they want it:** evaluation by what learners do, which funders increasingly ask for and surveys cannot give.

DRAFT

36 Do you primarily provide products or services directly to individuals, to other organizations, or to the government?

READY

ANSWER

Organizations (B2B)

WHY

Schools and NGOs now; government (B2G) is the aim, and the written answers can say so.

37 What is your plan for becoming financially sustainable, and what evidence can you provide that this plan has been successful?

300 WORDS | WRITE | FACTS NEEDED

SOLVE ASKS

How money comes in (grants, donations, sales, government contracts, investment) and evidence it has worked so far: grants received, revenue, funder names and amounts where they can be shared.

MATERIAL

- **Grants and CSR funds.** India's Companies Act requires large companies to spend 2% of their profits on social causes, and education is an eligible area.
- **A paid workplace version.** Retake for adults, as gender-fair decision training for companies, can be sold to fund the free school version.
- **Later, state education departments** paying for the assessment as part of their programmes.
- **Evidence to date.** *Team: grants received, partner schools, CSR conversations, with names and amounts if they can be shared. If there are none yet, say what is in progress, honestly.*

DRAFT

SECTION 6 · SUBMIT

Last checks. Then the team lead submits.

Check	Done
Every required question answered, in English, within its limit	
The four claims on page 2 hold in every answer: no users, no student version yet, reading not validated, no behaviour claim	
The UNDP figures confirmed in the original report, or removed	
Our own numbers (students reached, sessions, team, funding) checked by the person who knows them	
The video is public or unlisted, and the link opens when signed out	
The demo link shared only if the team agreed	
Submit Solution clicked by Monday 2 November; the final deadline is Friday 6 November, 12:00 pm US Eastern	

SOURCES · CHECKED 22 OCTOBER 2026

1. **MIT Solve, 2027 Global Learning Challenge** (solve.mit.edu/challenges/2027-global-learning-challenge): the questions, dimensions, stage definitions and deadline used here.
2. **UNDP, 2023 Gender Social Norms Index:** nearly 9 in 10 people hold at least one bias against women; India 99.2% (2010 to 2014 data). Found in secondary summaries; confirm in the UNDP report before citing.
3. **Moss-Racusin and colleagues (2012),** "Science faculty's subtle gender biases favor male students", PNAS: identical applications, the male name rated more competent and offered a higher salary.
4. **Forscher and colleagues (2019),** "A meta-analysis of procedures to change implicit measures", Journal of Personality and Social Psychology: changes in implicit scores did not carry into behaviour.
5. **Devine and colleagues (2012),** "Long-term reduction in implicit race bias: a prejudice habit-breaking intervention", Journal of Experimental Social Psychology.

Unlearn. Relearn. Grow.